Deep Research Report:
Glass Candles in A Song of Ice and Fire

2026-07-04

Source categories: Canon texts | Authorial statements | Fan scholarship | Antecedents

44 sources catalogued | 53 findings across 4 research agents | 12 claims cross-referenced

30 URLs verified: 23 live, 6 blocked-but-confirmed, 1 redirect, 0 dead

Date: 2026-07-04

Source categories: Canon texts | Authorial statements | Fan scholarship | Literary/mythological antecedents

Total sources: 40 unique | Findings analyzed: 53 across 4 agents

Executive Summary

Glass candles are among the most economical devices in A Song of Ice and Fire: the phrase appears in only five chapters across three novels, yet it carries the series' entire "return of magic" argument and, by wide analytical consensus, the machinery George R.R. Martin will use to connect far-flung storylines in the endgame.

Bottom-line findings, in order of confidence:

1. The complete canon inventory is small and verifiable. Full-text search confirms every occurrence: A Clash of Kings Daenerys V (Ch. 63), A Feast for Crows Prologue, Samwell IV (Ch. 35), Samwell V (Ch. 45), and A Dance with Dragons Daenerys II (Ch. 11). Nothing in A Game of Thrones, A Storm of Swords, the Dunk and Egg novellas, or The World of Ice and Fire (all in the searched index), and (with slightly less certainty, since it is not indexed) nothing in Fire and Blood. HIGH CONFIDENCE.
2. Only one burning candle is ever witnessed by a point-of-view character: Sam sees Marwyn's obsidian candle at the Citadel (AFFC Samwell V). Every claimed power (seeing across distances, entering dreams, speaking half a world apart) comes from Marwyn's mouth, not from a demonstrated act; the closest to demonstration is Alleras nodding at the candle when Sam asks how Marwyn knew he was coming. HIGH CONFIDENCE.
3. The candles function as the text's cleanest barometer of returning magic: dark for at least a century, they reignite in Qarth (reported) and Oldtown (witnessed) after Daenerys hatches her dragons, and Quaithe announces "The glass candles are burning" as a herald of converging players. HIGH CONFIDENCE.
4. Quaithe-as-candle-user is inference, not text; Euron-as-candle-user is theory, and the TWOW sample chapter "The Forsaken" contains zero mentions of candles or glass per fan transcript. GRRM has never explained candle mechanics, confirmed Quaithe's identity, or acknowledged a palantir inspiration; his on-record doctrine is to keep magic unsystematized and unexplained. MEDIUM-HIGH CONFIDENCE (well-documented absences).
5. The strongest real-world antecedents are Tolkien's palantiri (functional match: far-seeing plus two-way communication, with the danger of who is on the other end) and the documented tradition of obsidian scrying: John Dee's Aztec "spirit mirror" (confirmed Mexican obsidian by a 2021 peer-reviewed study in Antiquity) and Tezcatlipoca's "Smoking Mirror" divination. The influence claims are labeled inference; the antecedents themselves are documented fact. HIGH CONFIDENCE on the facts, MEDIUM on influence.

A notable negative result: the widely quoted vigil line "a lie held against the light casts shadows" does not exist in the text; it is fanon. The verified vigil lesson is Armen's speech that the unlightable candle teaches "even with knowledge, some things are not possible."

No source category failed. All four agents returned valid results on the first attempt.

1. Background and Context

Glass candles are tall, twisted candles of obsidian (dragonglass) said to have been brought to Oldtown from Valyria a thousand years before the Doom. The Citadel, the maesters' great school in Oldtown, keeps four: one green, three black (AFFC Prologue, reported as Citadel lore). For centuries they would not light, and the order turned that failure into a teaching ritual: the night before taking his vows, an acolyte stands vigil in darkness with an obsidian candle he cannot light, learning humility about the limits of knowledge.

They matter because ASOIAF is structured as a world where magic died and is coming back. The candles are Martin's on/off indicator light for that arc, and, if Marwyn's account of their powers is true, they are also the only known magic in the series that permits deliberate two-way communication at global range, which has obvious plot value for a story whose cast is scattered across two continents.

2. Key Findings

2.1 The canon inventory (HIGH)

Full-text search of the novels (via the asearchoficeandfire.com Meilisearch index) returns 11 paragraph-level hits for "glass candle(s)", confined to five chapters:

- ACOK Daenerys V (Ch. 63): first mention in the series. Xaro Xhoan Daxos, after the House of the Undying burns: "It is said that the glass candles are burning in the house of Urrathon Night-Walker, that have not burned in a hundred years." Doubly hedged hearsay, listed among other magic-returning omens.
- AFFC Prologue: Pate's knowledge of the four candles and their Valyrian provenance; Armen's description of the vigil; Lazy Leo's claim that Marwyn's candle burned ("The light was queer and bright... the flame never flickered"); Leo's thesis line: "Old powers waken. Shadows stir. An age of wonder and terror will soon be upon us, an age for gods and heroes."
- AFFC Samwell IV (Ch. 35): the dying Maester Aemon "spoke of dreams and never named the dreamer, of a glass candle that could not be lit and eggs that would not hatch." (This mention is omitted by AWOIAF's Glass candle article; it was recovered by full-text search.)
- AFFC Samwell V (Ch. 45): the only POV-witnessed burning candle. Sam observes it in Marwyn's chambers: "three feet tall and slender as a sword, ridged and twisted, glittering black... 'It burns but is not consumed.'"
- ADWD Daenerys II (Ch. 11): Quaithe's apparition: "The glass candles are burning. Soon comes the pale mare, and after her the others. Kraken and dark flame, lion and griffin, the

> sun's son and the mummer's dragon. Trust none of them. Remember the Undying. Beware the perfumed seneschal."

Terminology note: the compound "obsidian candle" never appears (zero hits); the text says "a candle of obsidian," and the smallfolk word is "dragonglass."

2.2 Physical properties and the vigil ritual (HIGH)

Established on the page: obsidian composition; tall, twisted form with ridges "said to be as sharp as razors" (acolytes cut their fingers trying to light them); unnaturally bright, unflickering flame; light that distorts color ("whites were bright as fresh-fallen snow... but the shadows were so black they looked like holes in the world"); "it burns but is not consumed."

The vigil: the night before an acolyte says his vows he stands a night vigil in the vault with no other light source, only an obsidian candle he cannot light. Armen's stated lesson: "even with knowledge, some things are not possible." A common fan framing error corrected here: the vigil attaches to taking vows generally, not specifically to forging the Valyrian steel link (the rare link for study of the higher mysteries). And the oft-quoted "a lie held against the light casts shadows" is not in the text.

The real-world echo is precise: the medieval knight's Vigil of Arms (a squire's all-night watch in a chapel before dubbing, described in Ramon Llull's 13th-century Book of the Order of Chivalry) fused with the church tradition of the vigil candle as watchful truth. Martin inverts the symbol: the candle of truth that will not light in a disenchanted world.

2.3 Powers: claimed, implied, never demonstrated (HIGH)

The full catalog of powers comes solely from Marwyn, describing what Valyrian sorcerers "could" do: "The sorcerers of the Freehold could see across mountains, seas, and deserts with one of these glass candles. They could enter a man's dreams and give him visions, and speak to one another half a world apart, seated before their candles." His magical theory: "All Valyrian sorcery was rooted in blood or fire."

The nearest thing to a demonstration: Marwyn knew Sam was coming and sent Alleras to intercept him; asked how, "Alleras nodded at the glass candle." An implication, not a witnessed act. This claimed-versus-confirmed distinction matters because Marwyn declares himself unreliable: speaking of Aemon, he says "His blood was why. He could not be trusted. No more than I can."

2.4 The reawakening arc (HIGH)

The three books build one consistent timeline: candles brought from Valyria over a millennium ago; unlightable in living memory at the Citadel; dark "a hundred years" in Qarth; then, after the dragons hatch, reignition reported in Qarth (ACOK), witnessed in Oldtown (AFFC), and generalized by Quaithe (ADWD). The candles are the series' cleanest index that the dragons' birth restarted magic worldwide. Only the Oldtown instance is POV-confirmed.

2.5 Who is using them (MIXED)

- Marwyn (near-canon, HIGH): his candle burns on the page and the Alleras nod implies active scrying. The least contested inference in the fandom.
- Quaithe (mainstream theory, MEDIUM-HIGH): her ADWD apparition matches Marwyn's power catalog point for point: not physically present ("Are you here?" "No."), unseen by guards, a prior dream-visit she insists was real; when Missandei arrives Quaithe is simply gone, and Dany thinks: "A shadow. A memory. No one." But no candle is ever shown in her possession; the mechanism is inferred from her own line "The glass candles are burning" plus the power match. GRRM's only posture on Quaithe is "read and find out."
- Urrathon Night-Walker (canon hearsay, identity unknown): candles reportedly burning in his Qarth house; he never appears on the page. His only mention in the novels is that single ACOK line.
- Euron Greyjoy (contested theory, MEDIUM-LOW): the TWOW sample "The Forsaken" shows Euron force-feeding Aeron shade of the evening and apparently sending him visions, plus claimed dream-appearances and a genuine voyage to Valyria. The candle-user reading (PoorQuentyn and others) competes with the drug/shadow-magic reading (Steven Attewell: "If Euron could do that, why does he need the shade of the evening?"). Decisive negative check: a full fan transcript of "The Forsaken" contains zero occurrences of "candle" or "glass." The sub-theory that Euron operated in Qarth as Urrathon Night-Walker (the name echoes Urrathon "Badbrother" Goodbrother, a kingsmoot-crowned ironborn king) is openly circumstantial.

2.6 The Citadel conspiracy and the grey sheep (MEDIUM-HIGH as seeded suspicion)

Marwyn's charge: "Who do you think killed all the dragons the last time around? Gallant dragonslayers armed with swords?... The world the Citadel is building has no place in it for sorcery or prophecy or glass candles, much less for dragons." He adds that Aemon was sent to the Wall because his Targaryen blood made him untrustworthy ("His blood was why. He could not be trusted"), that had Aemon reached Oldtown alive "the grey sheep might have had to kill him," and he departs for Meereen to reach Daenerys before the Citadel's envoy.

Independent in-text corroboration of maester distrust comes from Barbrey Dustin's "grey rats" speech in ADWD. Attewell's institutional reading adds a mechanism: the Citadel once contained working scholars of the higher mysteries who lost an internal power struggle, after which candle-lore decayed into a hazing ritual. GRRM has never confirmed the conspiracy outside the books; it remains a deliberately seeded, deliberately unresolved suspicion. The candles' reignition is the conspiracy's crisis: the "impossible" is becoming possible again inside the very institution built on its impossibility.

2.7 Quaithe identity theories (SPECULATION, GRADED)

- Shiera Seastar (leading theory, MEDIUM): symmetry with Bloodraven (his lover mentoring Dany as he mentors Bran), her sorcery and disappearance from the record, motive against

"the mummer's dragon." Counterargument (Radio Westeros): Quaithe's mask leaves her eyes visible, and Dany never notices Shiera's famous mismatched blue-and-green eyes.

- Ashara Dayne (fringe, LOW): rests on the unrecovered body; undermined by the same eye test and by Barristan's Ashara fixation never touching Quaithe.
- The sober null hypothesis (MEDIUM-HIGH among analysts): Quaithe is exactly what the text says, an Asshai'i shadowbinder with her own agenda, no secret identity required.
- Note: "the fisherman's daughter" is a Jon Snow parentage candidate, not a Quaithe theory; the research brief's suggestion otherwise was checked and rejected.

2.8 Thematic readings: truth, illusion, re-enchantment (INTERPRETIVE, WELL-GROUNDED)

The vigil frames the candle as "truth and learning, rare and beautiful and fragile things" (Armen); a maester must "cast light," and knowledge "can be dangerous" (the razor edges). For centuries the ritual taught the limits of knowledge; now the candles light, and the lesson inverts: the maesters' disenchanted worldview, not magic, is what's obsolete.

The fandom's taxonomy of far-seeing places the candles as the "technological" third leg of a triad: weirwood greensight (organic, past-heavy, demands Bran's body and life), R'hllorist flame-visions (divine, symbolic, unreliable, demands interpretation), and glass candles (artificial Valyrian craft: targeted, precise, two-way, demanding only training and power). That neutrality is the point: the same instrument serves Marwyn, Quaithe, or Euron, and the moral weight shifts to whoever's face the flame lights.

2.9 TWOW foreshadowing (SETUP CANON, PREDICTIONS LABELED)

Canon setup: Marwyn sails for Meereen intending to beat the Citadel's envoy to Daenerys ("The grey sheep will send their man on a galley, I don't doubt. With fair winds I should reach her first"), leaving Sam to train under his circle: Alleras (near-universally read as Sarella Sand), Lazy Leo, and "Pate," almost certainly a Faceless Man wearing the real Pate's face, inside the Citadel with access to candles and dragon lore. Quaithe remains in contact with Dany; Euron turns toward apocalyptic sorcery at Oldtown's doorstep (the Redwyne fleet battle looms).

Predictions from the analyst class (labeled speculation): Marwyn joins Dany's magical brain trust in Meereen; the candles become GRRM's switchboard connecting Oldtown, Meereen, Asshai, and the sea (the only magic specified as real-time two-way at global range, with users planted at every hub); in the dark version (PoorQuentyn's influential "Eldritch Apocalypse"), Euron seizes Oldtown's candles as "his palantir... to contact the Others," dragging the southern war into the war for dawn. The Faceless Man's purpose at the Citadel feeds theories about the order's interest in dragons.

2.10 The authorial frame: GRRM's silences and doctrine (HIGH on quotes, documented absences)

GRRM has never publicly explained glass candle mechanics, named their users, confirmed Quaithe's identity or method, confirmed the maester conspiracy, or acknowledged a palantir inspiration. Those absences were verified by repeated searches across the So Spake Martin

archive index, his site, and major interviews (with the caveat that the SSM archive blocks automated full-text search).

What he has said governs how to read the device:

- "I try to keep the magic magical - something mysterious and dark and dangerous, and something never completely understood." Codified magic is "an alternate kind of science... magical recipes... That's not really magic, is it?" (Meduza, 2017)
- On Tolkien as his model: "A big lesson was his handling of magic... I knew I wanted magic in Westeros but to keep it in the background. Keep it low-key and mysterious." (2019 Tolkien screening Q&A)
- On adjudicating magic and religion: readers "can try to puzzle out" the relations; no authorial answers coming. (io9, 2011)
- He describes rationing magic like a dial: "You can have too much magic in fantasy very easily, and then it overwhelms everything." (Meduza, 2017) The dragons themselves almost weren't literal (the pyrokinesis idea Phyllis Eisenstein talked him out of).
- Balticon 2016: he read "The Forsaken" after warning the audience that Euron is "similar in character to Ramsay Bolton. You are some sick motherfuckers" - the clearest signal of an expanded, sorcerous Euron in TWOW.

The practical upshot: expect the candles to do plot work in TWOW without ever getting a rulebook.

2.11 Real-world and literary antecedents (FACTS HIGH, INFLUENCE INFERRED)

- Tolkien's palantiri: indestructible far-seeing spheres of deep-black crystal enabling vision and mind-to-mind communication between paired stones; their signature danger is domination by a stronger will (Saruman ensnared, Denethor curated into despair; "the stones never lie" but can be aimed). Tolkien scholarship (Shippey) reads them as a warning against scrying itself. GRRM's reverence for Tolkien is on record ("I revere Lord of the Rings... it had an enormous effect on me"), but no statement ties candles to palantiri; the parallel is analysis. Labeled differences: obsidian versus crystal; a candle that must light versus an always-on stone; Martin's tide-of-magic activation mechanic has no Tolkien equivalent.
- John Dee's obsidian mirror: the Elizabethan magus scryed with an Aztec obsidian "spirit mirror" (British Museum), geochemically sourced in 2021 to the Pachuca quarries near Mexico City (Campbell et al., Antiquity 95(384), pXRF analysis). Dee, Elizabeth I's "philosopher," employed Edward Kelley as medium to converse with "angels" through the glass. A historical scholar-magus seeking hidden knowledge in black volcanic glass is the closest real template for Marwyn the Mage, though no source links GRRM to Dee.
- Tezcatlipoca, "Smoking Mirror": Aztec priests scryed in polished obsidian mirrors (tezcatl); the god sees human thoughts and deeds through the mirror that replaces his foot. Getty and museum sources document the practice.

- The scrying family: catoptromancy at the Temple of Demeter at Patras (Pausanias), hydromancy, crystallomancy; the Persian Cup of Jamshid reflecting "the whole world" for legitimate kings of a lost golden age; Snow White's truth-telling, person-locating mirror (folklore motif D1323.1), itself rooted in medieval scrying-mirror lore.
- Obsidian itself: volcanic glass whose conchoidal fracture yields edges sharper than steel scalpels, matching the razor-ridged candles exactly; premier material of Mesoamerican blades and divinatory mirrors. The resonance with dragonglass ("frozen fire," the substance that kills the Others) is interpretive.
- Academic frame: Shiloh Carroll's Medievalism in A Song of Ice and Fire and Game of Thrones (D.S. Brewer, 2018) anchors the scholarly conversation on Martin's realism-versus-magic tension; no located peer-reviewed work treats the candles specifically.

3. Points of Contradiction

6. Euron's vision-sending mechanism. Candle-user reading (PoorQuentyn, sothoryos.com) versus drug/shadow-magic reading (Attewell). Canon check weighs against the candle version as written: "The Forsaken" transcript contains no candle or glass language, and Aeron's visions follow forced shade-of-the-evening. Assessment: Euron plainly has sorcerous reach; the candle is the weaker-evidenced mechanism.
7. Quaithe = Shiera Seastar. Thematic symmetry and motive versus the visible-eyes problem (Dany describes Quaithe's eyes without noting mismatched colors). Assessment: genuinely split among serious analysts; the null hypothesis (a shadowbinder, full stop) requires no identity at all.
8. AWOIAF versus the text on the vigil. The wiki says the vigil is stood "with nothing but the three black candles"; the novel says "only a candle of obsidian," singular, color unspecified. The text wins.
9. Fanon quote versus text. "A lie held against the light casts shadows" does not exist in the corpus; the verified lesson is "even with knowledge, some things are not possible." Two agents independently flagged this.
10. Marwyn's power catalog: fandom shorthand treats far-seeing/dream-entry/communication as established fact; the canon agent's structural reading shows it is all Marwyn's claim, with one implied demonstration. Not a contradiction between sources so much as a precision correction the report adopts throughout.

4. Single-Source Claims

- No glass candles in Fire and Blood (canon agent only; that volume is not full-text searchable, so this rests on AWOIAF citation practice plus search absence). MEDIUM. The TWOIAF absence, by contrast, is directly confirmed: the volume is in the search index (1,820 paragraphs) and returns zero hits. HIGH.
- Aemon's Samwell IV deathbed mention (canon agent only, but verbatim-verified text; its absence from AWOIAF is the interesting part). HIGH.
- Euron = Urrathon Night-Walker (one speculative essay; openly circumstantial). LOW.

- The Citadel's "lost magical civil war" institutional reading (Attewell alone, framed as possibility). MEDIUM-LOW.
- GRRM's Octocon "less Campbell and more Lovecraft" remark (single compilation source, possibly paraphrased). MEDIUM-LOW.
- The Balticon "sick motherfuckers" wording varies slightly across con reports (event itself multiply attested). MEDIUM-HIGH.

5. Practical Implications

For a reader or essayist working with this material:

11. Cite the five chapters, not the folklore. The corpus is small enough to quote exactly; several widely repeated "facts" (the fanon vigil quote, the three-candle vigil, obsidian candle as a term) fail verification.
12. Preserve the claimed/witnessed distinction. The entire power set is Marwyn's testimony; treating it as demonstrated flattens what Martin built as an unreliable-narrator scene.
13. Rank the users: Marwyn (near-certain), Quaithe (strong inference), Urrathon (hearsay cipher), Euron (contested theory with a real negative result against it).
14. Expect no rulebook. GRRM's on-record doctrine guarantees the candles will act in TWOW without ever being explained; arguments that depend on precise mechanics are built on sand.
15. The strongest antecedent framing for essays is the obsidian-scrying tradition (Dee, Tezcatlipoca) layered under the palantir function, with the influence claims labeled as inference.

Open questions: whether Quaithe's mechanism is ever shown on the page; whether Euron reaches Oldtown's candles; what the Faceless Man wants at the Citadel; whether the green candle differs from the black three (the text is silent).

Appendix A. Claim Cross-Reference Matrix

Y = category supports the claim; N = category evidence weighs against it; - = category did not address it. Categories: Canon texts, Authorial statements, Fan scholarship, Antecedents.

Claim	Canon	Author	Fandom	Anteced.	Agreement	Notes
Candles reignited worldwide after the dragons' birth (index of returning magic)	Y	-	Y	-	Full agreement	Only the Oldtown instance is POV-witnessed
Marwyn keeps a burning glass candle at the Citadel	Y	-	Y	-	Full agreement	The one on-page burning candle
Powers: far-seeing, dream-entry, two-way speech at global range	Y (claimed only)	-	Y (often as fact)	-	Partial	All powers are Marwyn's testimony; one implied demonstration (Alleras's nod)

Quaithe reaches Daenerys via glass candle	Y (inferred)	- (RAFO)	Y (theory)	-	Partial / inference	Mechanism matches Marwyn's catalog; no candle shown in her hands
Euron possesses or uses a glass candle	N (no text)	-	Y (contested theory)	-	Conflicting	'The Forsaken' transcript: zero hits for candle/glass; drug reading competes
The Citadel conspired to kill the dragons and suppress magic	Y (claimed)	- (never confirmed)	Y (theory)	-	Partial	Marwyn + Barbrey Dustin in-text; GRRM silent; deliberately unresolved
Quaithe is Shiera Seastar	-	- (RAFO)	Split	-	Conflicting	Thematic symmetry vs the visible-eyes counterargument
Glass candles were modeled on Tolkien's palantiri	-	N (no statement found)	Y (analysis)	Y (analysis)	Partial	Functional match is real; influence is inference atop GRRM's documented Tolkien debt
The vigil quote 'a lie held against the light casts shadows' is fanon, not text	Y (0 hits)	-	Y (flagged)	-	Full agreement	Negative finding, independently confirmed twice
Obsidian scrying is a documented real-world tradition (Dee, Tezcatlipoca)	-	-	-	Y	Single category	Peer-reviewed (Antiquity 2021) and museum sources; high reliability despite single category
GRRM deliberately keeps magic unsystematized and unexplained	-	Y (verbatim quotes)	Y (corroborates)	-	Full agreement	Meduza 2017, io9 2011, 2019 Tolkien screening
Four candles at the Citadel: one green, three black	Y (reported lore)	-	Y (wiki errs on vigil detail)	-	Agreement with correction	AWOIAF says vigil uses 'the three black candles'; text says one candle of obsidian

6. Source Reliability Matrix

Aggregate score = source-type weight x agent confidence x URL status + corroboration bonus (capped at 1.0). Thresholds: 0.80+ High, 0.50-0.79 Medium, below 0.50 Low. Low here does not mean wrong; it flags fan essays, forum posts, and unverified pages whose claims are labeled as speculation in the body.

Source	Year	Category	Agent conf.	URL status	Score	Cited by
A Search of Ice and Fire (mrdziuban): Full-text search index of the ASOIAF corpus	2026	Canon (primary text)	High	Live	**1.00 High**	canon, fact-check
Campbell, Healey, Kuzmin & Glascock / Antiquity 95(384): The mirror, the magus and more: reflections on John Dee's obsidian	2021	Academic	High	Live	**1.00 High**	antecedents

mirror						
Getty Research Institute: Obsidian Mirror-Travels: Through the Obsidian Mirror	n.d.	Museum	High	Live	**1.00 High**	antecedents
Westeros.org: The Citadel: So Spake Martin archive	n.d.	Primary archive	High	Blocked (Cloudflare)	**0.80 High**	author, canon
Meduza: 'Fantasy needs magic': An interview with George R.R. Martin	2017	News/interview	High	Live	**0.80 High**	author
io9 / Gizmodo (C.J. Anders): GRRM explains why we'll never meet any gods in ASOIAF	2011	News/interview	High	Live	**0.80 High**	author
WinterIsComing.net: GRRM explains what he borrowed from J.R.R. Tolkien	2019	News	High	Live	**0.80 High**	author
WinterIsComing.net: GRRM's early plans didn't include dragons (Eisenstein)	2017	News	High	Live	**0.80 High**	author
Wikipedia (citing Shippey, Pearce, Kocher): Palantir	2024	Reference	High	Live	**0.80 High**	antecedents
Smithsonian Magazine: Dee's 'spirit mirror' has Aztec origins	2021	News	High	Live	**0.80 High**	antecedents
World History Encyclopedia: Obsidian in Mesoamerica	n.d.	Reference	High	Live	**0.80 High**	antecedents
PoorQuentyn (E. Booth): What is the Grand Maester Conspiracy?	2016	Fan scholarship	High	Live	**0.80 High**	fandom, author
Race for the Iron Throne (S. Attewell): Full analysis of 'The Forsaken' (Aeron I)	2016	Fan scholarship	High	Live	**0.80 High**	fandom, canon
nobodysuspectsthebutterfly: Glass candles explainer	2015	Fan scholarship	High	Live	**0.80 High**	fandom, antecedents
A Wiki of Ice and Fire: Glass candle (chapter citations)	2024	Fan reference	High	Blocked (Wayback verified)	**0.76 Medium**	canon, fandom, antecedents
EBSCO Research Starters: Scrying	n.d.	Reference	High	Not verified	**0.70 Medium**	antecedents
Carroll, S. / D.S. Brewer: Medievalism in A Song of Ice and Fire and Game of Thrones	2018	Academic monograph	High	Not verified	**0.70 Medium**	antecedents
Fafnir - Nordic Journal of SF&F Research: Review of Carroll (2018)	2019	Academic	High	Not verified	**0.70 Medium**	antecedents
PoorQuentyn (E. Booth): Eldritch Apocalypse	2019	Fan scholarship	High	Live	**0.70 Medium**	fandom
PoorQuentyn (E. Booth): Glass candles ask (Euron/palantir parallel)	2016	Fan scholarship	High	Live	**0.70 Medium**	fandom
Radio Westeros: On Quaithe = Shiera Seastar (the eyes problem)	2016	Fan scholarship	High	Live	**0.70 Medium**	fandom
A Wiki of Ice and Fire: Quaithe; Marwyn; Alleras; Urrathon Night-Walker	2023	Fan reference	High	Blocked (Cloudflare)	**0.66 Medium**	canon, fandom
The Tolkien Society: GRRM on Tolkien (quote compilations)	2014/2019	Organization	High	Blocked (search-verified)	**0.64 Medium**	antecedents
Tor.com / Reactor: New	2016	News	High	Redirect	**0.64**	author

Greyjoy chapter revealed at Balticon				(reactormag)	Medium	
Medievalists.net: The Knighting Ceremony: From Squire to Sir (Llull)	2017	Reference	Med-High	Not verified	0.60 Medium	antecedents
Tolkien Gateway: Palantiri	2024	Fan reference	High	Blocked (search-verified)	0.56 Medium	antecedents
Live Science: Dee's spirit mirror came from the Aztec Empire	2021	News	Medium	Not verified	0.56 Medium	antecedents
The Wertzone (A. Whitehead): New TWOW chapter unveiled at Balticon	2016	Con report	Medium	Live	0.56 Medium	author
asoiafuniversity: Significance of the glass candles	2019	Fan scholarship	Med-High	Live	0.53 Medium	fandom
TheHawke (fan transcript): TWOW excerpt transcript: The Forsaken (Aeron I)	n.d.	Fan transcript	Medium	Live	0.49 Low	canon
Wars and Politics of Ice and Fire: A Forsaken Man Lashed Above the Chesapeake	2016	Con report	Medium	Live	0.49 Low	author
Race for the Iron Throne (S. Attewell): TWOIAF analysis: From the Dawn to the Doom	2014	Fan scholarship	Medium	Live	0.49 Low	fandom
USC Scalar (ENG 283E): The Cup of Jamshid	n.d.	Academic teaching	Medium	Not verified	0.49 Low	antecedents
nobodysuspectsthebutterfly: Magic in ASOIAF and in LOTR (quote compilation)	2017	Fan compilation	Medium	Live	0.49 Low	author
Wikipedia: Scrying; Catoptromancy; Cup of Jamshid; Magic Mirror; Tezcatlipoca; Ceremonial lights; Obsidian in Mesoamerica	2024	Reference	Medium	Not verified	0.39 Low	antecedents
Nerdist: History of Thrones: The Maesters of Oldtown	2017	News/feature	Medium	Not verified	0.39 Low	author
Speculative Literature Foundation: GRRM deep dive	n.d.	Organization	Medium	Not verified	0.39 Low	author
Sothoryos.com: Euron Greyjoy and the Glass Candles (Euron is Urrathon)	n.d.	Fan theory	Low	Live	0.38 Low	fandom, canon
Westeros.org forum: A star of the sea: Quaithe = Shiera Seastar	2014	Forum essay	Medium	Not verified	0.34 Low	fandom
liesandarbor: A Falling Star in Westeros Pt II: Ashara Dayne	2018	Fan essay	Medium	Not verified	0.34 Low	fandom
Lucifer means Lightbringer (Mythical Astronomy): Bloodstone Compendium (glass candle discussion)	2016	Fan essay	Medium	Not verified	0.34 Low	fandom
agentrouka-blog: What do you think glass candles represent?	2021	Fan essay	Medium	Not verified	0.34 Low	fandom
History of Westeros: HOW interviews GRRM	n.d.	Fan podcast	Medium	Not verified	0.34 Low	author
Stars Uncounted: GRRM the Anti-Tolkien	n.d.	Fan essay	Low	Unreachable	0.20 Low	author

Summary: 44 sources total; 14 high reliability, 15 medium, 15 low; 0 dead URLs (none needed replacement).

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